I remember it still. I have never forgotten it. It takes me the imallest effort to jump the intervening decades, see the store, the street, my brother at eight, and his face crumpling at the deceit I had practiced on him. Thirty-two years later (at a time I will describe in due course) I finally brought the matter up, apologized once again, and said 'If you don't forgive me, Stan, 111 carry this to my grave."

He frowned and said, "I forgive you, I forgive you, but I don't emember it at all."

He probably forgot it after half an hour; I carried the scar for a third of a century. It is surely better to be wronged than to do wrong.

I think it was also in the year 1937 ^at m y Grandfather Aaron

died. When he fell sick, my father's younger brother, Abraham Ber

who had taken to calling himself Boris), took him to Moscow for

medical treatment, and there he died. I have no idea when either of my

grandmothers died.

News from Russia was very slim and intermittent. Worse yet, my : ather and mother discussed what news there was, but never talked about it to me. It was a life I had not shared and they hugged it to themselves.

My Diary

With the new year of 1938, a turning point came in my personal life that might have seemed of the most trival character.

I started a diary.

In itself, this was not remarkable. I believe that almost any youngster who is reasonably articulate and introspective sooner or later tries his hand at a diary so that he might record his momentous acts and thoughts. Why should I be an exception?

In most cases, I suspect, a diary lasts for a few days, a few weeks, a year at most. Sometimes, though, it endures, and in my case it did. It is still going on today, and dozens of annual diaries stand side by side on my shelf like good and faithful soldiers, each of them, with one or two exceptions, in the same